

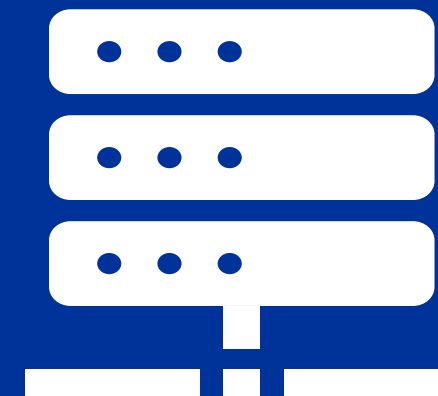
COTE D'IVOIRE

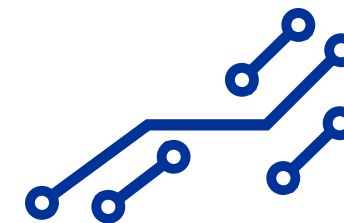
DATA CENTER MARKET BRIEFING

A strategic overview of the data center investment opportunity in Cote d'Ivoire

A Xalam Analytics Country Report

January 2026



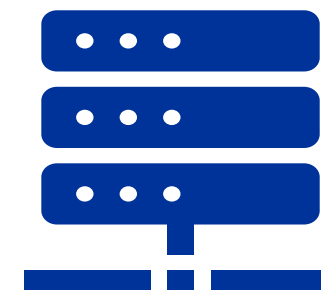


This report is part of a series of market briefs developed by Xalam Analytics at the behest of Digital Investment Facility (DIF) under the Data Governance in Africa Initiative, on the data center market opportunity in sub-Saharan Africa (“SSA”). This analysis aims to provide key insights into market demand and supply patterns for data center markets, business landscape, regulatory impact and investment returns. The research aims to provide potential investors and stakeholders with the latest information on the data center market in the SSA region.

This country review is based on our assessment of information and data as available to our research. It is further underpinned by our understanding of the marketplace along with market data and insights collected through continuous research. The numbers and estimates in this report are derived from a mix of sources, including estimates from Xalam Analytics’ economic models, data providers, regulator data and other sources as may be indicated.

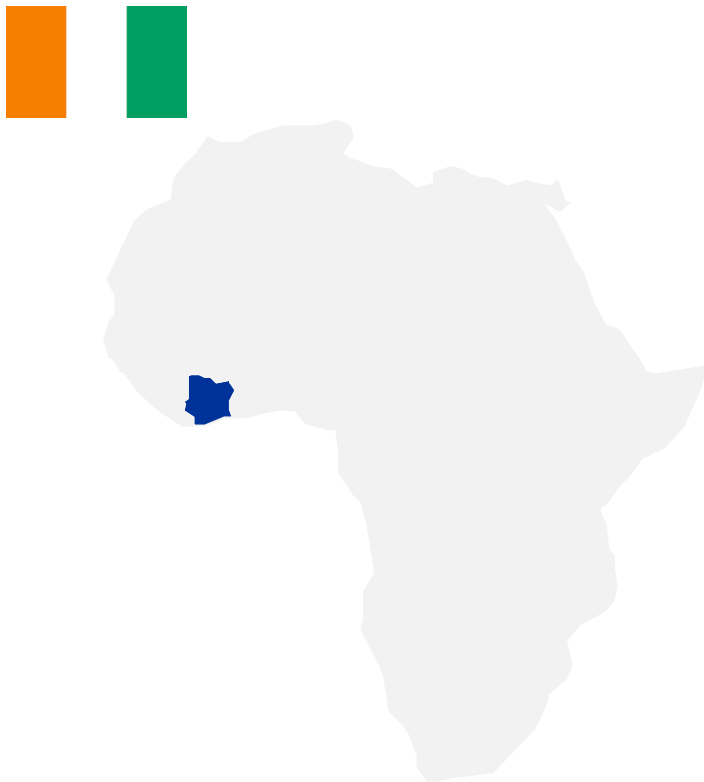
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The Cote d'Ivoire data center investment case

French-speaking Africa's most dynamic economy, with an opportunity to serve long-unaddressed demand for hosting capacity



THE OPPORTUNITY

- **An economic hub in francophone Africa;** accounts for nearly 40% of the GDP of the UEMOA monetary economic area.
- Cote d'Ivoire has **strong macro-economic fundamentals**, strong GDP growth track record, stable FX and a moderate inflationary environment.
- The country hosts a strong French-speaking multinational corporation base.
- Cote-d'Ivoire has **the largest ICT sector in French-speaking Africa**; a dynamic ICT market with double-digit annual growth.
- Limited carrier-neutral presence offers solid upside for data center specialists.

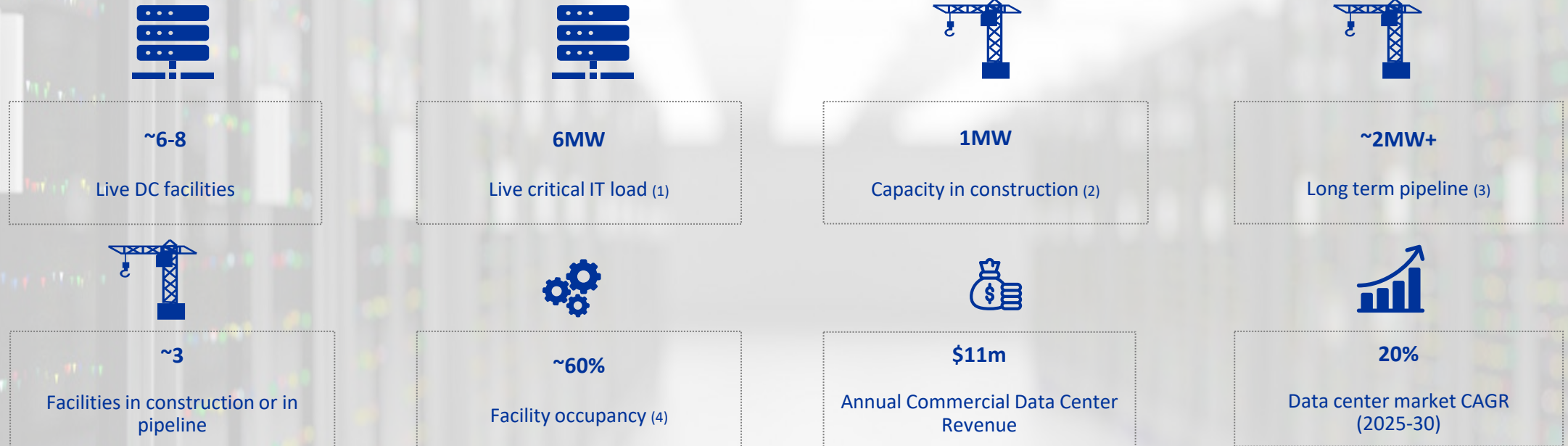


CHALLENGES & RISKS

- **Potentially high OpEx baseline;** power prices are among the highest in Africa, and only ~30% energy from renewable sources.
- **A moderately diverse fiber market;** fiber prices still at premium level.
- Some demand size risk; enterprise cloud adoption levels still relatively low; rate of adoption has been relatively moderate.
- **Strong competitive threat from telcos** in the enterprise segment.

Cote d'Ivoire data center market overview

Estimates as of 2025



(1) Capacity that is active, under lease or readily available for lease by third-party customers.

(2) IT load capacity from facilities currently in construction; construction has broken ground; ongoing civil works, installation and commissioning phases are in progress.

(3) Facilities explicitly announced or listed as in development. Some execution phases have been initiated (e.g. land control, energy supply commitments, etc.), but no actual civil works have been undertaken. Capacity expected to be available by the end of 2030.

(4) Percent of available capacity that is effectively being used by third party customers.

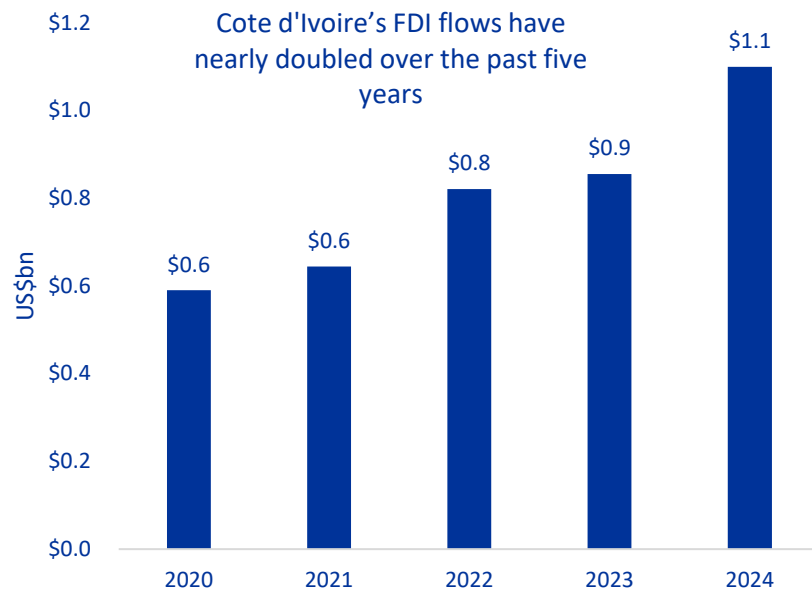
Sources: Xalam Analytics estimates, provider data

Key drivers of demand for data centers

One of Africa's fastest-growing economies, a phase of extensive infrastructure build, and strong connectivity adoption

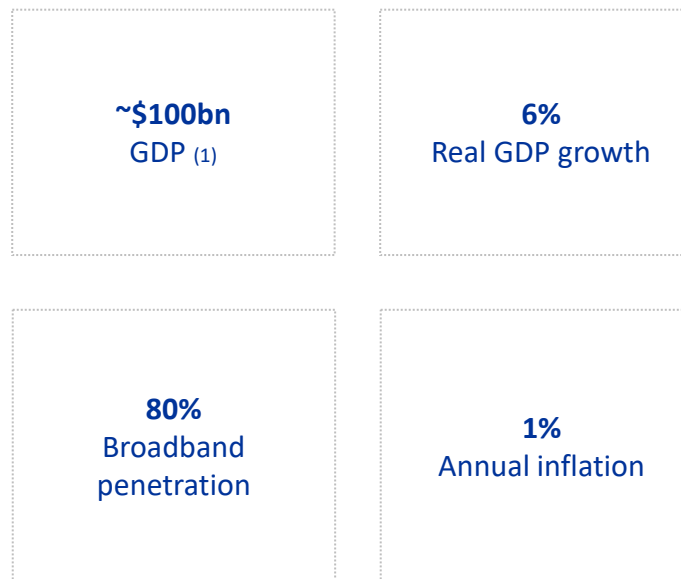
An acceleration in investment inflows - Cote d'Ivoire FDI

US\$ bn



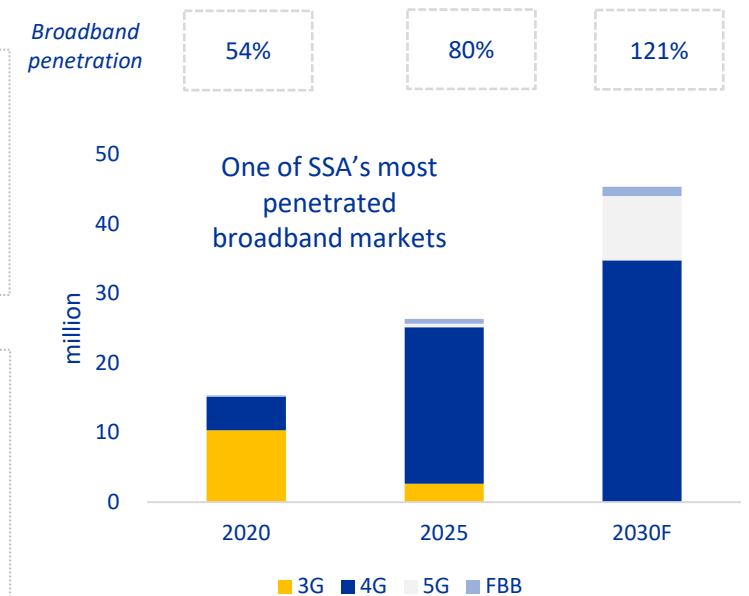
Deep economic transformation

Sample Cote d'Ivoire economic indicators - 2025



A more sophisticated digital customer base

Cote-d'Ivoire broadband connections by type - million



(1) Provisional, based on FX as of December 2025

Sources: IMF, CEPICI, INS, ARTCI; Xalam Analytics estimates, provider data

Data center market conditions

Cote d'Ivoire's market conditions are increasingly favorable to data center project development

Data privacy, hosting & environmental regulations



- A data Protection Law was enacted in 2013. Under the law, personal data cannot be stored overseas without the authorization of regulatory body ARTCI.
- Foreign cloud platforms generally allowed, so long as the data is stored in a market with data protection laws at least as stringent as the Cote d'Ivoire's.
- The government has outlined a national digital strategy; the government's vision is for Cote-d'Ivoire to become West Africa's digital hub; key pillars include achieving full national digital coverage, digitization of administrative processes, and investment in training and skills.
- Development of a national AI strategy and establishment of a roadmap for data value creation.

Investment Incentives



- Considerable investment in improving infrastructure.
- Enterprise creation process highly streamlined.
- Streamlined process for construction permits (~2-3 weeks).
- New startup law enacted in 2023 to foster the development of a startup ecosystem.

Electricity & Fiber Markets



- Cote d'Ivoire has a power generation capacity around 3GW.
- The government is targeting ~5GW of capacity within the next five years, including ~1.5GW of hydro and solar.
- ~30% energy mix from hydro sources, with a 2030 target of ~45%.
- Cote d'Ivoire power prices are relatively moderate and among the lowest in West Africa, at \$0.13/kWh.

Fiber Markets



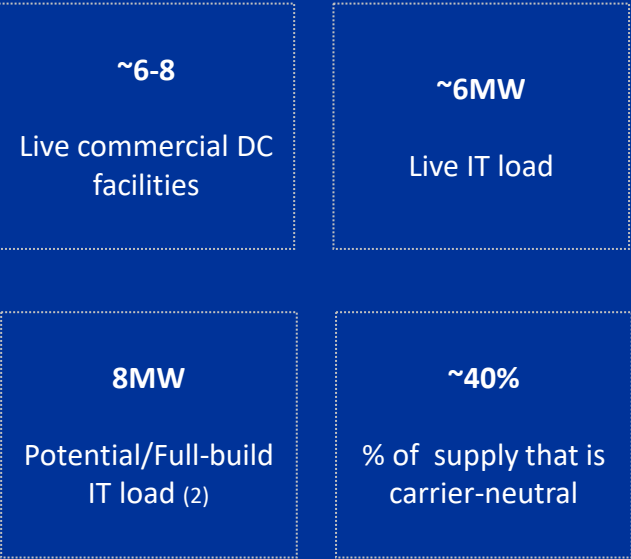
- Cote d'Ivoire has a relatively large wholesale market - the fourth largest in West Africa.
- A premium market – average terrestrial and subsea capacity prices at the higher-end. The Cote d'Ivoire is also the primary terrestrial to subsea route for landlocked Burkina Faso; key route for Mali.
- Diversity has improved considerably; ~1Tbps of equipped bandwidth, distributed across three primary providers and four main cable systems.
- The terrestrial fiber market has been opening up over the past few years.
- An average of ~1000 kms of fiber added annually; the country's top cities are well-covered by a fiber backbone.

State of data center supply

After years of slow growth, the Ivorian data center market is accelerating

Cote d'Ivoire data center supply – 2025E

Sample market indicators (1)



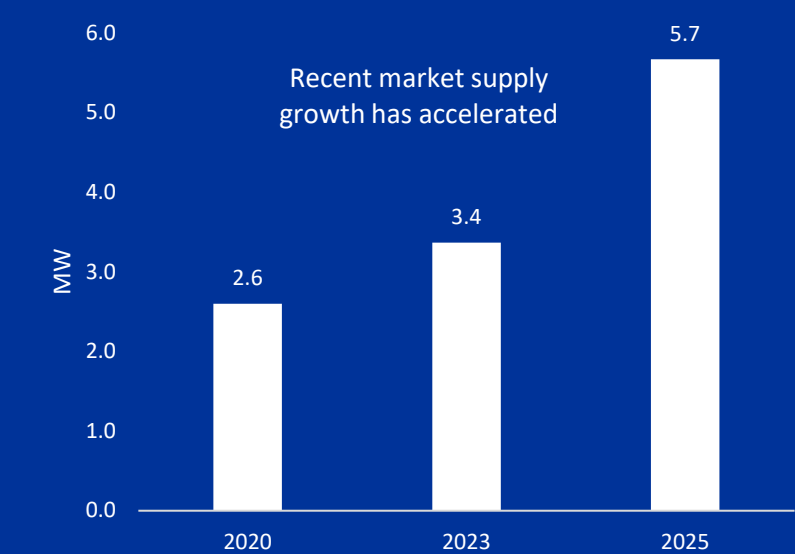
Cote d'Ivoire vs. Sub-Saharan Africa peers

Critical IT load – in MW



Cote d'Ivoire data center – evolution of live supply

Critical IT load - in MW



(1)Numbers are rounded up
Sources: Xalam Analytics estimates, provider data

Cote d'Ivoire facility mapping – Abidjan metro



Key data center market players

The arrival of new players has made for an increasingly competitive and diverse marketplace

Telcos, MSPs and infracos



Focused on mobility and fiber - colocation is an adjacent opportunity.

The Data Center Specialists



Carrier-neutral data center colocation pure plays

Government



State agency offering a range of IT services, including colocation

New entrants



More specialist providers expected to launch over the next 2-3 years

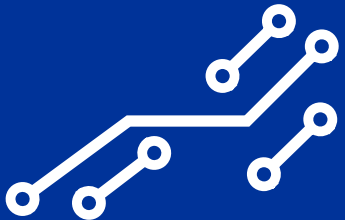
A moderately competitive market



- Cote d'Ivoire has an increasingly competitive DC market. There are four primary facilities (MainOne, Raxio, Orange and ST Digital), and a handful of smaller, non-certified facilities.
- The market has long been dominated by telcos MTN and Orange – but the arrival of carrier-neutral providers such as Equinix and Raxio, along with cloud specialists such as ST Digital is transforming market dynamics.
- Around half of available supply now comes from carrier-neutral types, an inflexion point in the maturity of this market; at least two specialist providers have had Cote-d'Ivoire in their pipeline.



GLOSSARY & KEY DEFINITIONS



Key definitions

Data center	While there are a variety of definitions for data centers, this market review is focused on commercial facilities , that is, facilities that lease colocation white space and power capacity to third-party customers on open, commercial terms, and in exchange for a fee. Captive facilities (bank data centers, telco switch sites and similar) are excluded from this assessment. Estimates focus on facilities at Tier II standard and above, unless otherwise indicated. Where applicable, these estimates include cloud hyperscaler self-built facilities.
Live critical IT load	Capacity that is active, under lease or readily available for lease.
Full build capacity	Data center facilities are typically built in phases; the full-build capacity is capacity assuming all potential phases of build have been completed and are live.
Capacity in construction	Facilities that have broken ground; ongoing civil works, installation and commissioning phases.
Pipeline	Facilities explicitly announced or listed as in development. Some execution phases have been initiated (e.g. land acquisition, power supply commitments, etc.), but no actual civil works have been undertaken.
Carrier-neutral	Facilities not specifically affiliated to a connectivity or cloud vendor, with capacity available to all third-party customers, on equal commercial terms, without explicit or implicit constraints or favoritism. This market review uses a loose definition for carrier-neutral, referring to facilities that are purely carrier-neutral, recognized by the market or effectively managed as such.

Glossary

Below are some of the key abbreviations used in this report

AI	Artificial Intelligence
ASN	Autonomous System Number
bn	billion
CAGR	Compound Annual Growth Rate
CapEx	Capital Expenditures
CDN	Content Delivery Network
Colo	Colocation
DC	Data Center
DIF	Digital Investment Facility
EAC	East African Community
EU	European Union
F	Forecast
FBB	Fixed Broadband
FDI	Foreign Direct Investment
FX	Foreign Exchange
GDP	Gross Domestic Product
GDPR	General Data Protection Regulation
ICT	Information, Communications and Technology
ISP	Internet Service Provider
IPP	Independent Power Producer
IT	Information Technology

kW	Kilowatt
kWh	Kilowatt Hour
LLM	Large Language Models
m	million
MNC	Multinational Corporation
MNO	Mobile Network Operator
MRR	Monthly Recurring Revenue
MSP	Managed Service Provider
MW	Megawatts
NDC	National Data Center
OEM	Original Equipment Manufacturer
POP	Point of Presence
PUE	Power Usage Effectiveness
RFS	Ready For Service
SEZ	Special Economic Zone
SSA	Sub-Saharan Africa
USD	US dollar
PUE	Power Usage Effectiveness
RFS	Ready For Service
SSA	Sub-Saharan Africa
YE	Year end



Learn more:

<https://d4dhub.eu/initiatives/data-governance-in-africa>

